

DECISIVE MOMENTS

MALAYAN EMERGENCY

In 1948, ethnically Chinese communist insurgents launched a guerrilla campaign against British and Commonwealth troops in the British colony of Malaya. However, the Malayan communists lacked popular support and had no friendly neighbor to supply them with arms. Although the communist campaign continued until 1960, it was eventually defeated by counterinsurgency tactics—a strategy that the US later used, with less success, in Vietnam.



» AFTER

The Geneva Conference in 1954 tried to secure peace deals for Korea and Indochina.

VIETNAM DIVIDES

After their devastating defeat at **Dien Bien Phu**, the French agreed to negotiate Vietnam's independence. The **Geneva Accords** that ensued divided Vietnam. The United States backed Ngo Dinh Diem as ruler of South Vietnam while North Vietnam became a communist state under Ho Chi Minh.